

COVER STORY: THE MELTDOWN

THE END OF GOOD TIMES

40

The stock market is in a tailspin, banks are gripped by a credit shock and companies are issuing pink slips. The Government must act to restore the virtuous cycle of investment-led growth, or destruction will run its course.



NATION: CONGRESS



Bahu Vs Behenji 20

The two most powerful women in the country get down and dirty as elections loom, vote banks clash and both jostle for power in Delhi.

DEFENCE: PIRACY

The Hijack Dilemma 55

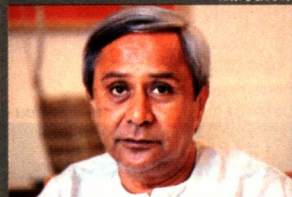
Somali pirates strike at will as the Government dilly-dallies on options to tackle the menace. With the best-equipped Navy, it only lacks the will power to do so.



STATES: ORISSA

Rider on the Storm 26

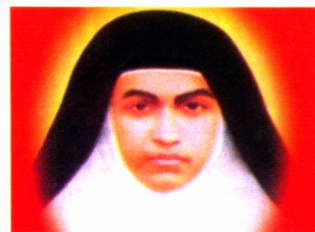
RAVI S SAHANI



The tribal unrest in Kandhamal has become the biggest political crisis for Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik, a popular politician who continues to challenge politics as usual.

RELIGION: SAINT ALPHONSA

God's Chosen One 64



SHANMUG

For Christians, the canonisation of Sister Alphonsa was a rare occasion for celebrations, coming at a time when the community is under attack in parts of the country.

SOCIETY&THE ARTS: BOOKS

Alone in Duskland 71

Aravind Adiga, this year's Man Booker Prize winner, is a first novelist who has taken an exhilarating ride through the darkest alleys of modern India.

SOCIETY&THE ARTS: CINEMA

Hollywood Calling 80



A strong domestic market beckons as India becomes the American studios' must-go-to destination for local language movies.

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Jobs Today ^{Turn to pg} 88

Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

COVER BY
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